

EXAMINED

Stuffcool Napoleon

The Stuffcool Napoleon is a high wattage charger that's compatible with a lot of the modern charging standards adopted by smartphones, tablets and thin form-factor laptops. Providing a 65W output in such a small form-factor is commendable but is now very common. The aptly named Napoleon is able to do so because it uses Gallium Nitride transistors for the primary switching circuit of the power supply. This allows the circuit to be made smaller compared to traditional power supplies which use massive transformer coils. The power board technology is called PowiGaN and is provided by Power Integrations, which is a Silicon Valley based supplier of power conversion products.

The Napoleon has two outputs, one being a Type-A connector with 18W output and the other being a Type-C port with 65W output. If both are used at the same time, then the Type-C connector's output drops to 45W since the overall capacity of the charger is rated at 65W and the Type-A port takes up 18W. The packaging states that it is compatible with Quick Charging technologies but doesn't state which all standards it does support. Lastly,



the Stuffcool Napoleon features several protection circuits such as Over Current Protection, Over Voltage Protection, Electrostatic Protection, Over Temperature Protection and Short Circuit Protection.

We tried the unit with a POCO F1 which supports Quick Charge 3.0 and we did see it charging rapidly. The same was repeated with the Samsung Galaxy S8 Plus and we did notice fast charging getting activated. We couldn't try out a laptop since none of the ones we hand on hand supported power delivery via Type-C. All in all, the the Stuffcool Napoleon is a pretty nifty charger.

PRICE - ₹3,599

Tata Sky Binge+

To cater to the TV viewing generation and the cord-cutting generation alike, Tata Sky has developed the Tata Sky Binge+ set-top-box. The box aims to give you the best of both worlds - the traditional TV viewing experience and the world of OTT apps. It is a hybrid between the traditional set-top-box and a streaming device. It can show you conventional TV channels, which means you still need the dish on your roof and a cable connecting the box to the dish. It also runs on Android, giving you access to OTT apps such as Prime Video, Zee5, Disney+ Hotstar Premium and more. To access these apps, you need to have an internet connection.

You can connect to the internet using Wi-Fi or Ethernet. It runs on Android TV Pie and comes with 2GB RAM and 8GB storage. It supports both 2.4 and 5Ghz Wi-Fi along with Blue-

tooth 4.2. At the back of the box it has an AV out, 2 USB ports, HDMI out and SPDIF. The HDMI port is HDMI 2.0 so it will work with 4K and HDR TVs and will also work with 1080p and HD ready TVs as well. Thanks to the AV out, you can connect it to older TVs as well.



Since it runs on Android, it also comes with Chromecast built-in. The box costs ₹2,999 for new customers and existing Tata Sky customers can get it for ₹2,499. It brings with it six months of subscription for Hotstar Premium,

Zee5 Premium, Voot Select, Voot Kids, Eros Now, Hungama Play, Sun NXT, Shemaroo Me and three months of Amazon Prime Subscription.

So, should you buy it? It depends on your current setup and your desire to consume content from OTT platforms. The good thing is you get access to a bunch of OTT platforms for a mere ₹299 per month and if you include Amazon Prime, it is ₹428 a month. But if you already have subscriptions to these services or some of the partner services don't excite you, then the package seems less exciting. Add to it the fact that you can only consume this partner OTT content on the set-top-box and not on your smartphone or laptop, and its appeal reduces a little more. Remember, you need to have an active Tata Sky connection to take advantage of the OTT platforms as, without an active connection, you cannot use the box as a streaming device.

PRICE: ₹2,999